64

The AI Runs My App

A TikTok and Instagram series: an AI gets EUR 100 and a chess app.
It does the work. I post. Can it make money?

Series plan, odds and budget · October 2026

1. The idea in one breath

You hand an AI a finished chess app, **64**, and EUR 100. The AI decides what to build, what to charge, what to post and how to spend the money. You do only what a human legally or physically has to do: sign, film, post, press the buttons. Every episode shows the AI's decision of the week, the budget left, and the real numbers.

> **Hook: "I gave an AI EUR 100 and told it to make my app money. I only press the buttons."**

Why it can work: "AI does my job" stories are among the most-watched formats right now, and building in public gives people a reason to follow along week after week. The series itself is marketing for 64: every episode is an ad nobody skips, because the story is the content.

The plot twist is built in. The first thing the AI must do is pay Apple's developer fee of **EUR 99 a year**, without which the app can't be sold at all. That is almost the whole budget, so either make that episode two ("The AI spent 99% of its money in five minutes") and give the AI a separate EUR 100 for marketing, or let it start with EUR 1 and earn the rest. Both are good TV; the first is more realistic.

2. Can AI really do 90% of the work?

Counted by tasks, yes: roughly 85 to 90%. Counted by hours, you will spend about 10 to 20% of the total time, mostly filming and posting. Some things must be you, because Apple, TikTok and the law require a person.

Area	AI does	You do
The app	All code, design, sounds, boards, onboarding, paywall, fixes, updates, tests	Install it, try it, say what feels wrong
App Store	Name, subtitle, keywords (EN/DE/NL), description, screenshot texts, privacy policy, review notes	Enroll in the Developer Program (ID check), bank and tax details, EU trader address, press Submit
Pricing	Prices, trial, Founder offer, when to change them	Approve
Content	Episode scripts, hooks, captions, hashtags, shot lists, edit notes, thumbnails, AI B-roll	Film your face, hands and screen recordings (about 20 minutes a week)
Posting	When to post, what to post next, replies drafted for comments	Post and reply (platforms limit automation, and real replies matter)
Money	Budget plan, spend decisions, weekly report	Pay with your card, approve each spend
Growth	Reads the numbers, finds what works, chooses the next experiment, writes creator outreach	Send the messages from your account

Your 10%, in time: about 3 to 5 hours in the first month (setup, Apple enrolment, first filming), then 1 to 2 hours a week.

3. The odds, honestly

These are my estimates, based on the growth review of 64 and published subscription-app benchmarks, not guarantees.

Question	Likelihood	Why
AI does about 90% of the work	High (about 80%)	Code, copy, design, plans and scripts are already being done by AI in this project. The remaining human steps are small and fixed.
64 makes its first sale within 30 days of launch	Likely (about 60-70%)	Even modest content usually brings a few hundred downloads; at 1-2% conversion that is a handful of buyers.
EUR 100 a month in profit within 6 months	Possible (about 35-50%)	Needs roughly 10-15 downloads a day from posts and search.
EUR 500 a month after 12 months	Base case of the review	About 45 downloads a day at 2% conversion. Needs steady posting and a good App Store page.
EUR 2,000+ a month	Unlikely without a hit (about 10-15%)	Needs a format that keeps going viral, or Apple featuring the app.
The series itself goes viral (100k+ views on one video)	Reasonable (about 30-40% over 3 months)	The format is strong; it depends on hooks and consistency more than on the app.

> **The bigger prize may be the audience, not the app: a following for "AI runs my business" can be worth more than 64's subscriptions, and it carries over to the next app.**

4. The EUR 100 budget

On top of the EUR 99 Apple fee. The rule for the AI: no money is spent until free channels show what works.

When	Spend	On what	Why
Weeks 1-4	EUR 0	Organic posts, free Pro codes for 10-20 chess creators, Reddit and chess clubs	Find the hook that works before paying for reach.
Week 5-6	EUR 20	Boost the single best-performing video (TikTok Promote or Instagram Boost)	Only pay to push what already works.
Week 6-8	EUR 40	Apple Search Ads test, EUR 5-7 a day, keywords like "chess for two"	Only if at least 2.5% of downloads pay and there are 20+ ratings; stop after EUR 40 if not.
Anytime	EUR 15	Thumbnails, a simple landing page or a month of an editing app	Small things that lift every post.
Reserve	EUR 25	Whatever the numbers say, decided on camera	Gives the series a "what will the AI do?" moment.

Show a budget tracker on screen in every episode: "EUR 100, now EUR 80 left". It is simple, honest and makes people come back.

5. The first 12 episodes

#	Title / hook	What happens
1	"I gave an AI EUR 100 to make my app money"	The premise, the app in 15 seconds (sound on), the rules: AI decides, I only press buttons.
2	"The AI spent 99% of its money in five minutes"	Apple's EUR 99 fee. The AI explains why there was no choice.
3	"I asked AI what my app is worth"	The AI picks prices: monthly, yearly, lifetime, and the Founder deal. Show the reasoning.
4	"The most satisfying chess app?"	The sounds: heavy pieces knock deeper, the king falls over. Pure ASMR, the AI explains how it made them.
5	"AI wrote my App Store page"	Name, keywords, screenshots. Before and after.
6	"Apple is reviewing the AI's app"	Submission, the wait, rejected or approved (both are good episodes).
7	"Launch day: the AI's plan"	Live numbers through the day. First download, first comment.
8	"Our first sale"	The moment money comes in. Show the real App Store Connect screen.
9	"The AI read 1,000 comments"	What people asked for, and what the AI changes because of it.
10	"The AI spent EUR 20 on one video"	The first paid boost. Did it work? Real numbers.
11	"30 days of AI as my CEO"	Downloads, money, hours I worked versus hours the AI worked.
12	"Should I fire the AI?"	The honest verdict so far, and the next experiment. Ask viewers to vote.

Between story episodes, post short "satisfying" clips of the app itself (sound close-ups, the falling king, rain ambience). They are cheap to make and point back to the series.

6. The weekly routine

Who	Task	Time
AI	Reads last week's numbers, writes the weekly report, decides the next move and budget	-
AI	Writes 3-4 scripts with hooks, captions, hashtags and a shot list	-
You	Film everything in one session: face to camera, hands on the iPad, screen recordings	20-30 min
You	Edit with the AI's notes (CapCut templates keep it quick)	30-45 min
You	Post on schedule, reply to comments for the first hour	15 min per post

Posting rhythm: 4 videos a week for the first month, then 3. Same time of day, roughly 18:00-21:00.

7. Rules that keep it believable

- **Real numbers only.** Show App Store Connect and the real budget. Faking one number ruins the series.
- **Label AI content.** TikTok and Instagram ask for it, and the honesty is part of the appeal.
- **Real hands, real iPad.** Use AI images only for b-roll and thumbnails; AI video of people looks fake and viewers notice.
- **Let the AI be wrong on camera.** Failed experiments are the best episodes; people love a plot twist.
- **One question per video.** "Will it work?" "Should I fire the AI?" Comments push the algorithm.

8. Risks

- **"Lazy" backlash.** Answer with transparency: show what you actually do and the hours.
- **Apple review.** A rejection delays launch by days; it also makes a good episode. The app already has the required Terms and Privacy links.
- **Running out of steam.** The weekly routine is short on purpose. Batch-film two weeks at once when you can.
- **Slow sales.** Likely at first. The series can still grow, and the audience is reusable for the next app.

9. What to do this week

- Enroll in the Apple Developer Program (EUR 99) and apply for the Small Business Program (15% fee instead of 30%).
- Create TikTok and Instagram accounts with the same handle, for example @64.chess or @play64app.
- Film episode 1: you, the iPad, the premise in 20 seconds, the sound of a piece landing.
- Ask the AI for the scripts of episodes 2-4 and the App Store page.
- Create a free TelemetryDeck account and send the App ID, so the AI can read real usage numbers.

Sources for the numbers: the 64 growth review (marketing/64-growth-review.md), RevenueCat State of Subscription Apps 2026, Apple developer pricing and EU business terms. Probabilities are estimates.